

Veterans Backbone – Boundaries & Professional Conduct Policy

Purpose

This policy establishes the standards of behaviour expected across Veterans Backbone.

It applies to staff, volunteers, trustees, contractors, external professionals, and anyone representing the organisation.

Expected Standards

Individuals are expected to:

- Treat others with dignity and respect.
 - Maintain appropriate professional boundaries.
 - Communicate honestly and professionally.
 - Act in ways that promote safety and wellbeing.
 - Work within their role and competence.
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Professional Relationships

Relationships should:

- Remain professional.
- Support independence.
- Avoid dependency.
- Maintain appropriate accountability.

Individuals must not use their position for personal gain or influence.

Prohibited Conduct

The following are not acceptable:

- Exploitation of any kind.
 - Harassment, bullying, intimidation, or discrimination.
 - Abuse of authority or position.
 - Coercive or manipulative behaviour.
 - Favouritism that compromises fairness or safety.
 - Breaches of confidentiality.
 - Conduct that creates safeguarding concerns.
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Communication Standards

Communication should be:

- Respectful
- Honest
- Appropriate
- Professional

Disagreements should be handled constructively and without hostility.

Digital & Online Conduct

The same standards apply online as offline.

Social media, messaging apps, email, and digital communication should never undermine professional boundaries or safeguarding requirements.

Raising Concerns

Concerns regarding conduct or boundaries should be raised promptly.

Concerns will be reviewed fairly, proportionately, and in accordance with safeguarding, complaints, and governance procedures where appropriate.

Accountability

Breaches of this policy may result in:

- Additional supervision
- Training requirements
- Restrictions of duties
- Formal investigation
- Removal from role where necessary

The response will depend on the seriousness of the concern.

Review

This policy is reviewed periodically and following significant incidents, safeguarding concerns, or organisational learning.

Final Statement

Professional conduct is not about perfection.

It is about behaving in a way that protects trust, safety, dignity, and accountability across Veterans Backbone.